DAY 30 · THEORY HANDOUT

Choose a Document Converter

Compare simple Markdown conversion with layout-aware document reading.

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The idea and its useful terms

Compare simple Markdown conversion with layout-aware document reading.

Markdown

Plain text with marks for headings and lists.

MarkItDown

Converts many file types into readable text.

Docling

Builds a document structure and exports its contents.

A shared text format makes many file types easier to handle with the same prompt. The converter reads the file before the model sees anything.

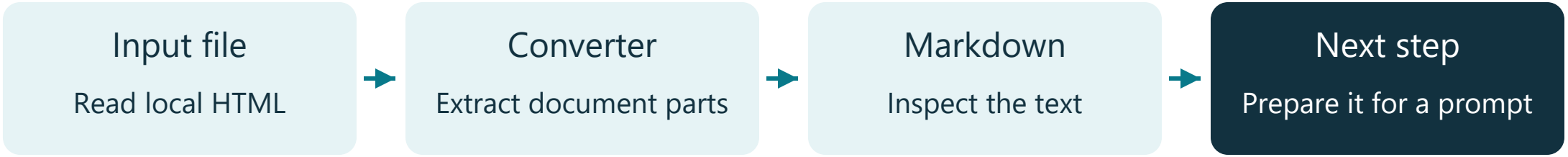
Docling can handle layout, tables, and OCR with suitable pipelines. Some options download models and need more computer memory.

> A converter helps read a file. It does not guarantee that every table or image becomes correct text.

Follow the work, one step at a time

Each step has a job. We can inspect its output before moving on.

Read the path from left to right.



Each arrow means: pass the result to the next step.

MarkItDown returns text_content. Docling returns a structured document that we can export as Markdown. We compare these actual outputs with the same source heading and table before using them in a prompt.

The HTML exercise reads existing text and needs no OCR model. Complex PDF tables, scans, audio, and pictures use other pipelines or extras. Choose them for a file that needs them, and inspect their output.

> If the answer is wrong, inspect the input and the intermediate results. The last sentence alone cannot show which step failed.

A small example we can check

The values here are classroom examples. The notebook shows actual results.

Original page

Heading: Workshop.

A two-row timetable.

MarkItDown

Heading and table text.

Check the row order.

Docling

Document items to text.

Inspect table structure.

Read the given input first. Point to the fact or value needed for the requested output.

Run the matching example, then try the fresh input at the end of the notebook. Compare both results with the known input.

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Choose the setting or tool for its job

A different choice changes the work. These are the choices we compare.

Simple text file

Keep a simple reader.

No heavy pipeline needed.

Mixed file types

Try MarkItDown.

Inspect missing parts.

Complex PDF layout

Consider Docling and OCR.

Allow extra setup time.

Convert the same local HTML with both tools. This path needs no OCR model.

Compare the heading and table rows in both Markdown outputs.

> Write the Markdown to a new file. Keep the original so we can check what changed.

Practice, check, and read the full lesson

Use the notebook to try the steps. Use the article when you need the longer explanation.

1. Build

Run the small example.

Inspect each step.

2. Change

Try the fresh input.

Keep the goal clear.

3. Check

Compare with the source.

Keep mistakes visible.

Write the Markdown to a new file. Keep the original so we can check what changed.

Read the complete tutorial breakdown for this section in our KGP Talkie article.

> A converter helps read a file. It does not guarantee that every table or image becomes correct text.

DAY 30 · COMPLETE

Thank You

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